Problem Statement Template · Expert version

A problem statement template helps you describe a problem clearly before jumping to solutions: who is affected, what happens, where and when, its impact and the outcome you want.

How to use this template

1. Answer who, what, where and when with facts.
2. Quantify the impact.
3. Add evidence and the desired outcome.
4. Note constraints.
5. Combine it all into one or two sentences that everyone agrees on.

Tips

- Do not include a solution in the statement.
- Use numbers wherever possible.
- Test it with stakeholders.
- Use it to open your business case or BRD.

Problem statement · Describe the problem, not the solution

Element	Prompt	Your answer
Who	Who is affected?	Customers updating their account details
What	What is the problem?	They must call support to change details
Where / when	Where and when does it happen?	Every day, mostly at month-end billing
Impact	What does it cost? Quantify.	3,200 calls a month; 9-minute average handling time
Evidence	Data or research that shows it.	Call logs Jan-Mar; customer survey
Desired outcome	What does good look like?	Customers self-serve; calls down 30%
Constraints	Limits on any solution.	Must use existing billing system
Problem statement	Combine into one or two sentences.	Customers cannot update account details online, causing 3,200 support calls a month; we want them to self-serve and cut calls by 30% this year.